Q&A: Supplier Market engagement briefing – 13 April 2022

For further information on the Federated Data Platform please use the Supplier Briefing slides, shared on our e-tendering portal.

What is the process for Procurement?

- NHS England is currently focused on procurement 1, lot A and B (see briefing slides for more information). Appropriate market engagement related to procurements 2 and 3, includes anticipated timelines, will be shared with the market prior to commencing any procurement activity.
- Subject to meeting the requirements of the tender documentation, it is anticipated that either a single supplier or consortium will be able to bid for this opportunity. This will be clarified in the tender documentation.
- All requirements and evaluation criteria will be made clear in the tender documentation.

How will the FDP interact and connect with source systems?

- One of the objectives of the FDP is to enable connectivity between Trusts, ICSs and the National Teams. This will be achieved in the following ways:
    - Each organisation (Trusts, ICSs, National) will have opportunity to own separate instances (partitioned infrastructure) to enable separation of concerns and use case pertaining to direct care, population health and proactive care, planning, oversight and service improvement (NHS/care and non-NHS) and research and innovation.
    - The FDP will adopt a common data model aligned to the use cases to enable interoperability between the instances. This is important, as we are not intending to use the FDP to collect wholesale data not relevant to the specific use cases.
    - The governance and separation of data uses will be enabled by the privacy-enhancing technology (Lot 1B) in accordance to the enterprise architecture and will be available as part of a set of core national services outside of the platform.
    - We have developed a set of four integration patterns ranging from a common data connection data pipeline to full adoption of the FDP (please refer to slide 16). We expect all Trusts or ICS to fall in accordance with the integration patterns, dependant on use case.
- The FDP will be a secure data environment and will both store data as well as support access to data for operational and internal analysis purposes only. It will not be a Trusted Research Environment (TRE), which is an environment for research and innovator access to data. The FDP and it's instances will be a source data provider for the planned NHS supported TREs, including those developed and hosted regionally (Sub National Trusted Research Environment).

How does the FDP relate to other programmes of work taking place in the NHS? Will it replace existing programmes of work?

- The FDP will build upon existing infrastructure. There will be no gaps in service provision during transition and mobilisation.
- The FDP will be an ecosystem of technologies and services implemented across the NHS in England.
- The FDP will be built on five use cases:
    - Population health and person insight; Care coordination (ICS); Elective recovery (Trust); Vaccines and immunisation and Supply Chain.
- We are working through the integration and alignment with other programmes and further information will become available as we work through this.

What are the next steps for Suppliers?

- The RFI deadline has been extended until 23:59 on 25 April 2022.
- It is anticipated that a follow up briefing will take place week commencing 9th May – it will be open to all interested suppliers
- The anticipated contract start date is November 2022.